

41% OF WOMEN SAY THEY WATCH PORN WITH HUSBANDS

Falguni Peacock (FP): It is very different for a woman. But as a mature individual I would weigh the pros and cons of what transpired. A major part of the marriage would be over, but there would be an effort on my part to look beyond it.

LK: Having an affair is circumstantial. But I would analyse to see whom it was with, the intensity, the duration and if it was impulsive or whether there was a thought process to it. I would forgive and look beyond. It doesn't always have to be severance. I don't equate everything with sex.

Q. Love marriages pale in comparison with arranged marriages, with 76 per

phies. Until then the paradigm won't really shift.

Q. Does the liberated and open-minded tag of women today go bust with 45 per cent having been subjected to forced sex?

HS: The definition of "forced sex" again would mean the refusal of the modern women to be doormats. It is an era of ambivalence with the transition from blind acceptance to reluctant refusal, where the woman yields but with silent protest. This is a paradigm shift that takes a generation. Empowerment that comes from holding a job takes time to influence other areas of life and other power equations. Hence this find-

Shane Peacock (SP): I would accept it. It is his or her sexual choice. I wouldn't like it, because after all we want our children to be normal.

Q. Today, is pre-marital sex a norm, making virginity a thing of the past?

LK: Sex is a part of development. The entire issue of pre-marital sex is old fashioned and virginity is passe. The question of wanting to preserve yourself for someone special doesn't mean anything—what if he is not so special after all?

PK: Today women stay single till 30 plus. They too have needs, why should they suppress them?

Q. Are sexual attitudes in India still conservative?

PK: Definitely. There is no concept of a sex shop, and the thought of a girl going into shop to get a vibrator is unheard of.

LK: Experimentation has only gone to the point of lingerie, not beyond.

Q. Is work the only factor taking a toll on the sex lives of married couples?

SP: Marriage is a commitment. It involves give and take. There are no set rules. Post-nuptial depression can take place. There is an increase in stress at work that extra marital affairs provide an outlet to.

HS: Post-nuptial depression could take place when adjustment takes a long time, there is a delay in having children, you are temporarily dislocated or if you are married against your will. But I do not see too much of this, I see more distress than depression. Those who have a meaningful vocation and a support system around them will live through this.

"EXPERIMENTATION HAS ONLY GONE TO THE POINT OF LINGERIE."

LUKE KENNY
FORMER VJ AND PRODUCER

cent of Indian men still preferring an arranged marriage as do 78 per cent of women. Comment.

HS: Men still choose their spouse through their parents in the urban metropolis. The market has grown much faster than the minds. As glass buildings soar and multiply, a large proportion of those occupying it are from small towns. The development leap in terms of choosing the spouse will take a generation. Also the feudal set-up in families still exists. So where is the time to decide about a spouse?

PK: We are still a highly patriarchal society in which major decisions are made by heads of families. Even people who move to big cities from smaller ones will take a generation or so to be truly integrated and adopt so-called modern philoso-

ing is not surprising but reveals a society in transition

PK: Forced sex happens irrespective of financial independence. It's based on the idea that sex is a right for the man. It's a power thing and one that will remain until the man truly considers a woman an equal whether she is a bread earner or a housewife.

Q. How would you react to your child saying he was homosexual?

HS: I would be shocked and it would take time to get over it. I would try and find out if it was an experimental thing and seek professional help for him. I am a father first, and a psychiatrist later.

PK: I wouldn't care if my child was homosexual...as long as he or she is happy. I would try to make their lives easier. I would definitely support them, their sexual leanings are incidental



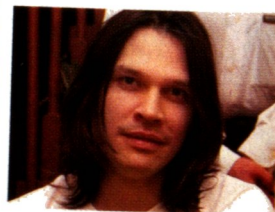
DR HARISH SHETTY 48

SOCIAL PSYCHIATRIST,
From Mumbai. Father
of two teenage boys.



PAYAL KHANDWALA 33

ARTIST, has shown in
galleries in India and
abroad. Is to marry soon.



LUKE KENNY 36

FORMER VJ, writer-producer
and fledgling director.
In a live-in relationship.



**FALGUN PEACOCK 31 &
SHANE PEACOCK 33**

DESIGNERS, they specialise
in trousseau wear and
custom-made garments.
Parents of a six-year old,
they have been married
for seven years.